Electronic Data Destruction and Sanitization

WyIT.2013

Policy Owner	Department of Enterprise Services, Data Privacy
Policy Contact	Pat Potter, Deputy Chief Data Officer
Policy Approver	Wyoming Data Governance Committee (WDGC)
Effective Date	September 12, 2025
Next Review Date	April 1, 2027
Policy Version	2026-09.1

Scope:

This policy establishes requirements for protecting state electronic data resources through proper data destruction and sanitization procedures. It provides agencies with guidance on how to properly handle data destruction and sanitization within the State of Wyoming, ensuring compliance with data privacy and security regulations.

This policy addresses the secure disposal of electronic media containing state data to prevent unauthorized access, data breaches, and compliance violations.

Authority

This policy is promulgated under the authority of Wyoming State Statute 9-2-2906 and its subsections, the Department of Enterprise Technology Services is required to adopt and enforce information technology standards, and promote efficient use of information technology throughout state government.

Specifically, this policy is further promulgated under the authority of the below listed Wyoming State Statute subsections.

- Implements and maintains an information technology governance program for state agencies (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (ii));
- Establishes and enforces data security and privacy policies and standards for the state data infrastructure Establishes review criteria for the agencies information technology projects, procurements and purchases. (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (iii)); and

Adopts information technology policies and standards and ensures agency compliance with those policies and standards (W.S. 9-2-2906,(b), (vi)).

Audience

This policy applies to all Executive Branch agencies, boards, and commissions staff (collectively referred to as "agencies"). This policy is also applicable to consultants, affiliates, third party vendors and temporary employees that use or store state data.

Definitions

Key Definitions, Acronyms, and Terms

Policy Statements:

1. The agency may create agency-specific policies that meet the outlined scope, purpose, and requirements as stated in this policy. In lieu of agency-specific policies that meet the outlined scope, purpose, and requirements as stated in this policy, this policy shall serve as the governing policy.
   [1], [2], [3]

2. Agencies may implement supplemental policies to augment this governing policy as needed. This policy does not supersede any State or Federal regulation and does not override, waive, or provide exemption from the requirements of the Wyoming Public Records Act (Wyoming Statute 16-4-201 through 205). Agencies remain fully obligated to comply with all legal requirements while implementing appropriate privacy safeguards for exempt information.
   [1], [2], [3]

3. The State CIO recognizes three levels of media sanitization:

   3.1. Clear: Perform a full manufacturer's reset, reinstall or a format of the storage to either restore the equipment to its factory default settings or simply format over the storage.

   3.2. Purge: Use crypto shredding, wiping, or degaussing in an organizationally approved degausser rated at a minimum for the media.

   3.3. Destroy: Shred, disintegrate, pulverize, or incinerate the device in a licensed incinerator.
   [4], [2], [5], [6], [3]

4. Agencies shall classify their data according to WyIT 2001 Information Classification levels and those levels shall determine disposal methods.
   [2], [8], [3]

5. Public Data:

   Media remaining within your agency (internal reuse, storage): The agency may choose to perform a clear sanitization (factory reset/format). Media transferred to another agency must be cleared.

5.1. Media remaining within your agency (internal reuse, storage): The agency may choose to perform a clear (factory reset/format).Media transferred to another agency must perform a clear.

5.2. If the media leaves the State's control, it must be purged. This can be done by the agency, contracted services, ETS, or Surplus Property.

[4], [2], [3]

6. Internal Data:

6.1. Media remaining within your agency (internal reuse, storage): The agency may choose to perform a clear sanitization (factory reset/format).Media transferred to another agency must perform a clear sanitization.

6.2. If the media leaves the State's control, it must be purged. This can be done by the agency, contracted services, or ETS.

6.3. If the media is not to be reused, it must be destroyed in a manner that renders the electronic media unreadable and unusable.

[4], [2], [5], [3]

7. Confidential Data:

7.1. If the media is not to be reused or is leaving the agency's control, it must be destroyed in a manner that renders the electronic media unreadable and unusable.

7.2. If the media is to be reused within the agency, it must be purged.

[4], [2], [5], [6], [3]

8. Agencies shall identify and comply with federal and state regulations where applicable as determined by the agency data owner.
[2], [7], [8], [3]

9. When verification of destruction is required, agencies shall contract with qualified vendors to provide documented proof of media destruction completion. Such verification shall include certificates of destruction that detail the destruction method, date, location, and witness information.
[4], [2], [9], [3]

Applicable State Policies, Federal, State or Industry Rules, Laws, and/or Regulations

1. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-100
2. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-53, Rev 5
3. ISO/IEC 27001
4. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-88, Rev 1
5. Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard (PCI DSS)
6. Health Insurance Privacy and Accountability Act (HIPAA), Security Rule
7. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cyber Security Framework (CSF) 2.0

8. WyIT 2001, Information Classification
9. International Secure Information Governance & Management Association), NAID AAA Certification
10. WyIT 2001-S1, Data Owner Standard
11. WyIT 2001-S2, Data Steward Standard
12. WyIT 2001-S3, Data Custodian Standard
13. WyIT 2001-S4, Data Domain Standard
14. WyIT 2001-G1, Information Classification Guide
15. WyIT 2001-G2, Information Classification Procedures Guide
16. WyIT 3015, Physical Media

Compliance & Exceptions:

Compliance

Employees who violate this policy may be subject to appropriate disciplinary action up to and including discharge as well as both civil and criminal penalties. Non-employees, including, without limitation, contractors, may be subject to termination of contractual agreements, denial of access to IT resources, and other actions as well as both civil and criminal penalties.

Exceptions

Requests for exceptions to this policy shall be reviewed by the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and the Chief Information Officer (CIO). Departments requesting exceptions shall provide such requests to the CIO in accordance with WyIT.3002 Policy Exception Request.

The request should specifically state the scope of the exception along with justification for granting the exception, the potential impact or risk attendant upon granting the exception, risk mitigation measures to be undertaken by the IT Department, initiatives, actions and a time-frame for achieving the minimum compliance level with the policies set forth herein. The CIO shall review such requests; confer with the requesting department.

Any exception to established policy shall be defined and tracked as a risk to the state and established mitigating controls monitored by the agency.

Review/Approval:

Date Issued/Review Date

This policy shall be reviewed at least annually and updated / reviewed / approved as defined in the Office of Chief Information Officer (OCIO) Policy lifecycle.

The review and update process shall be coordinated by Governance, Risk and Compliance (GRC), completed by the policy owner and approved through the OCIO policy review workflow.

To obtain a signed copy of this document, contact Enterprise Technology Services Governance, Risk and Compliance (ets-ocio-grc@wyo.gov).

Jeffrey Clines
Officer Name

Chief Information Officer
Officer Title

_____
Officer's Signature

_____
Date

Revision History

The current version of this policy, as identified in the Revision History below, supersedes all previous documents listed below.

Version	Change	Author(s)	Date of Change
2026-09.1	ETS Director Signature	GRC	September 2026
UKN	WyIT 2013, Electronic Data Destruction and Sanitization, Originally Published	Wyoming Data Governance Committee	February 2024
UKN	09400-P221, Electronic Hardware and Data Sanitization Policy	UKN	November 2018
UKN	09400-S221, Standard for Electronic Data Destruction and Sanitization	UKN	November 2018